

# Ryan Cory-Wright

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## Academic Appointments

**Imperial College London**, Imperial Business School  
Assistant Professor of Analytics and Operations

London, UK  
July 2023-present

### IBM Research

Herman Goldstine Postdoctoral Fellow

Cambridge, MA  
July 2022-June 2023

## Research Interests

- **Optimization:** integer, semidefinite, conic, polynomial
- **Machine learning and artificial intelligence:** interpretability, scientific discovery, large language models
- **Applications:** business analytics, energy (decarbonization, pricing schemes)

## Education

**Massachusetts Institute of Technology**, Operations Research Center

Cambridge, MA

PH.D. IN OPERATIONS RESEARCH

September 2017-May 2022

Advisor: Dimitris Bertsimas | Thesis: Integer and matrix optimization: A nonlinear approach

**University of Auckland**, Faculty of Engineering

Auckland, New Zealand

B.E. (1ST CLASS HONORS) IN ENGINEERING SCIENCE

February 2014-October 2016

Four-year degree completed in three years via accelerated pathway (extra class per semester)

## Working Papers

W7. *Compact Lifted Relaxations for Low-Rank Optimization*

**R. Cory-Wright** and J. Pauphilet, working paper.

W6. *Stability Regularized Cross-Validation*

**R. Cory-Wright** and A. Gómez, working paper.

W5. *Pricing Discrete and Nonlinear Markets With Semidefinite Relaxations*

C. Guo, L. Henderson, **R. Cory-Wright**, and B. Yang, working paper.

W4. *Improved Approximation Algorithms for Orthogonally Constrained Problems Using Semidefinite Optimization*

**R. Cory-Wright** and J. Pauphilet, invited for submission at special issue of **Mathematical Programming B**.

- Preliminary version accepted at IPCO 2026

W3. *Bridging the Gap Between Scientific Laws Derived by AI Systems and Canonical Knowledge via Abductive Inference with AI-Noether*

K. Srivastava, S. Dash, **R. Cory-Wright**, B. Trager, C. Cornelio, and L. Horesh, major revision at **Nature Communications**.

W2. *Disjunctive Branch-And-Bound for Certifiably Optimal Low-Rank Matrix Completion*

D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, S. Lo, and J. Pauphilet, major revision at **INFORMS Journal on Computing**.

W1. *Optimal Cross-Validation for Sparse Linear Regression*

**R. Cory-Wright** and A. Gómez, minor revision at **INFORMS Journal on Computing**.

## Journal Papers

J15. *Sparse PCA With Multiple Components*

**R. Cory-Wright** and J. Pauphilet, **Operations Research**, to appear, 2026.

- First place, INFORMS DMDA Workshop Paper Award (Theoretical Track, 2024)

J14. *The Need for Verification in Artificial Intelligence-Driven Scientific Discovery*

C. Cornelio, T. Ito, **R. Cory-Wright**, S. Dash, and L. Horesh, **Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society A**, 384(20240591), 2026.

- J13. *Decarbonizing OCP*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, and V. Digalakis Jr., **Manufacturing & Service Operations Management**, 27(6): 1760-1778, 2025.  
  - Finalist, M&SOM practice-based research competition (2023)
  - Honorable mention, MIT Operations Research Center Student Paper Award (Digalakis, 2023)
  - Featured in Imperial Business news article “Optimising renewables: a model for profitable decarbonisation” [link]
- J12. *A Stochastic Benders Decomposition Scheme for Large-Scale Stochastic Network Design*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, J. Pauphilet, and P. Petridis, **INFORMS Journal on Computing**, 37(5):1163–1181, 2025.
- J11. *Evolving Scientific Discovery by Unifying Data and Background Knowledge with AI Hilbert*  
**R. Cory-Wright**, C. Cornelio, S. Dash, B. El Khadir, and L. Horesh, **Nature Communications** 15:5922, 2024.  
  - IBM Outstanding Technical Achievement Award (2024)
  - Featured in IBM Research blog “Meet AI Hilbert, a new algorithm for transforming scientific discovery” [link]
- J10. *Sparse Plus Low-Rank Matrix Decomposition: A Discrete Optimization Approach*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, and N. A. G. Johnson, **Journal of Machine Learning Research**, 24(267):1–51, 2023.  
  - First place, INFORMS Data Mining Society Student Paper Award (2021)
  - A. E. Grant Poster Award for Best Algorithm, CAARMS (Johnson, 2022)
- J9. *A New Perspective on Low-Rank Optimization*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, and J. Pauphilet, **Mathematical Programming**, 202(1-2):47–92, 2023.
- J8. *Mixed-Projection Conic Optimization: A New Paradigm for Modeling Rank Constraints*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, and J. Pauphilet, **Operations Research**, 70(6):3321–3344, 2022.  
  - First place, INFORMS George Nicholson Student Paper Competition (2020)
- J7. *A Scalable Algorithm for Sparse Portfolio Selection*  
D. Bertsimas and **R. Cory-Wright**, **INFORMS Journal on Computing**, 34(3):1489-1511, 2022.
- J6. *Solving Large-Scale Sparse PCA to Certifiable (Near) Optimality*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, and J. Pauphilet, **Journal of Machine Learning Research**, 23(13):1-35, 2022.
- J5. *A Unified Approach to Mixed-Integer Optimization Problems With Logical Constraints*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, and J. Pauphilet, **SIAM Journal on Optimization**, 31(3):2340-2367, 2021.  
  - First place, INFORMS Computing Society Student Paper Award (2019)
- J4. *From Predictions to Prescriptions: A Data-Driven Response to COVID-19*  
D. Bertsimas, L. Bouissoux, **R. Cory-Wright** et al., **Health Care Management Science**, 24:253-272, 2021.  
  - First place, INFORMS Healthcare Applications Society William Pierskalla Paper Award (2020)
- J3. *On Stochastic Auctions in Risk-Averse Electricity Markets With Uncertain Supply*  
**R. Cory-Wright** and G. Zakeri, **Operations Research Letters**, 48(3):376-384, 2020.
- J2. *On Polyhedral and Second-Order Cone Decompositions of Semidefinite Optimization Problems*  
D. Bertsimas and **R. Cory-Wright**, **Operations Research Letters**, 48(1):78-85, 2020.
- J1. *Payment Mechanisms for Electricity Markets With Uncertain Supply*  
**R. Cory-Wright**, A. Philpott, and G. Zakeri, **Operations Research Letters**, 46(1):116-121, 2018.  
  - First place, Operations Research Society of New Zealand Student Paper Award (2016)

## Articles in Preparation

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- P4. *Sensor Location to Reduce Air Pollution*  
L. Meng, **R. Cory-Wright**, D. Den Hertog, and W. Wiesemann, in progress.
- P3. *Thinking Coherently About Interpretability*  
**R. Cory-Wright**, D. Keehan, and A. Jacquillat, in progress.
- P2. *msPCA: An R Package for Sparse PCA With Multiple Components*  
**R. Cory-Wright** and J. Pauphilet, in progress.
- P1. *A Shrinkage Path Heuristic for Wasserstein Distributionally Robust Optimization*  
L. Meng, **R. Cory-Wright**, and W. Wiesemann, in progress.

## Books in Preparation

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B1. *Integer and Matrix Optimization: A Nonlinear Approach*  
D. Bertsimas, **R. Cory-Wright**, and J. Pauphilet, in preparation.

## Selected Awards

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Note: \* denotes student paper award won by collaborator for coauthored work

- 2024 First place, **INFORMS DMDA Paper Award**, Theoretical Track
- 2023 Honorable mention, **Student Paper Award**, MIT ORC (Digalakis Jr.\*)
- 2023 Finalist, **Practice-Based Research Competition**, M&SOM Society
- 2022 **A. E. Grant Poster Award for Best Algorithm**, CAARMS (Johnson\*)
- 2022 **IBM Herman Goldstine Fellowship**, IBM Department of Mathematical Sciences
- 2021 First place, **Student Paper Award**, INFORMS Data Mining Society
- 2020 First place, **George Nicholson Student Paper Competition**, INFORMS
- 2020 First place, **Pierskalla Paper Award**, INFORMS Health Applications Society
- 2019 First place, **Student Paper Award**, INFORMS Computing Society
- 2017 **Senior Scholar Award** (top of cohort), University of Auckland
- 2016 First place, **Student Paper Award**, Operations Research Society New Zealand
- 2014-16 **Dean's List**, Faculty of Engineering, University of Auckland

## Teaching

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### IMPERIAL

Fundamentals of Python (MSc AI Applications and Innovation) *Imperial-X*  
COURSE CREATOR AND INSTRUCTOR *Fall 2025*

Introduction to Machine Learning in Python (MSc AI Applications and Innovation) *Imperial-X*  
COURSE CREATOR AND INSTRUCTOR *Fall 2024*

Decision Making Under Uncertainty (PhD) *Imperial Business School*  
COURSE CREATOR AND INSTRUCTOR *Spring 2024, 2025, 2026*

Data Structures and Algorithms (undergraduate) *Imperial Business School*  
COURSE CREATOR AND INSTRUCTOR *Spring 2024, 2025, 2026*

Optimization and Decision Models (Online MSc Business Analytics) *Imperial Business School*  
INSTRUCTOR *Spring 2024*

### MIT

15.095 Machine Learning Under a Modern Optimization Lens (MBAn/PhD) *MIT*  
HEAD TEACHING ASSISTANT *Fall 2019, 2021*

15.071 The Analytics Edge (MBA) *MIT*  
HEAD TEACHING ASSISTANT *Fall 2020*

15.093 Optimization Methods (MSc/PhD) *MIT*  
TEACHING ASSISTANT *Fall 2018*

Kaufman Teaching Certificate Program *MIT Teaching and Learning Lab*  
PARTICIPANT, eight practice-based workshops on teaching effectiveness *Fall 2021*

## Student Advising

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### POSTDOCTORAL FELLOWS

1. Dominic Keehan, *ICRF Postdoctoral Fellow at Imperial Business School* (co-advised with Wolfram Wiesemann, research at the intersection of optimization and AI).

### DOCTORAL STUDENTS

1. Lingjun Meng, *Third year PhD student at Imperial Business School* (co-advised with Wolfram Wiesemann, research on optimization under uncertainty with application to sustainability).

## Oral Presentations

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### INVITED PRESENTATIONS AT ACADEMIC INSTITUTIONS AND SINGLE-TRACK WORKSHOPS

#### *Improved Approximation Algorithms for Low-Rank Problems Using Semidefinite Optimization*

- Princeton ORFE 2026
- Imperial Analytics and Operations (internal seminar) 2026
- CMU Tepper OR 2025
- Michigan IOE 2025
- IBM Yorktown Heights 2025
- Workshop on Information Learning 2025

#### *Sparse PCA With Multiple Components*

- Cornell ORIE 2025
- Northwestern IEMS 2025
- Imperial-X 2024

#### *Evolving Scientific Discovery by Unifying Data and Background Knowledge with AI Hilbert*

- Cornell Tech 2025
- Turing Institute 2024
- Summer Workshop on Innovations in Management Science 2024

#### *Optimal Low-Rank Matrix Completion: Semidefinite Relaxations and Eigenvector Disjunctions*

- Toronto Rotman Young Scholar Seminar Series 2023
- Imperial College London Control and Optimization 2023
- Mixed Integer Programming Workshop 2023

#### *A New Perspective on Low-Rank Optimization*

- IBM Yorktown Heights 2024
- Lehigh ISE 2022

#### *Mixed-Projection Conic Optimization: A New Paradigm for Modeling Rank Constraints*

- IBM Yorktown Heights 2022
- Rice CMOR 2022
- CMU Tepper OR 2022
- USC Viterbi ISE 2022
- Georgia Tech ISyE 2022
- Johns Hopkins Carey OM 2022
- Princeton ORFE 2022
- Imperial Analytics and Operations 2021
- University of Auckland Engineering Science 2020

## INVITED PRESENTATIONS AT COMPANIES

### *The Future of Artificial Intelligence*

- South Port New Zealand Board of Directors Meeting

2024

## Other Academic and Industry Experience

Collaborations with organizations: Analytics for a Better World (2025-present), OCP (2021-22), CIBC (2017-20).

University of Auckland, Department of Engineering Science  
RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Auckland, New Zealand  
December 2016-July 2017

SUEZ Smart Solutions  
ASSISTANT OPTIMIZATION ENGINEER

Auckland, New Zealand  
December 2014-February 2016

## Activities and Service

### ORGANIZING SEMINARS AND WORKSHOPS

- 2027 Organizing committee, Mixed Integer Programming Workshop
- 2026 Cluster chair, INFORMS Optimization Society Conference
- Co-initiator and co-organizer, London Operations Research Day (LORD) [web link]
- 2024-27 2024 LORD at LBS, 95 registered participants; 2025 LORD at Oxford, 120 registered participants; 2026 LORD at Imperial, 100 registered participants; 2027 LORD at UCL
- 2019- Session chair, INFORMS Annual Meeting, ICCOPT, IOS, SIOPT, other conferences
- 2019 Co-organizer, MIT ORC student seminar series

### EXTERNAL

- 2025 Committee member, INFORMS Computing Society Student Paper Award
- 2024-26 Judge, M&SOM Student Paper Competition
- 2017- Member, INFORMS (Main, Computing Society, Optimization Society)
- Member, Mathematical Optimization Society

### IMPERIAL

Note: IB denotes service for Imperial Business School, ICL denotes service for Imperial College London

- 2025-26 Coordinator, Analytics and Operations Faculty Hiring *IB*
- 2025- Member, AI and Education Committee *IB*
- 2025- Member, Economics of AI initiative *ICL*
- 2023-25 Member, Interdisciplinary AI initiative (Imperial-X), *ICL*
- 2024-25 PhD early/late stage assessment committee, Yanwei Sun, Zhongze Cai, Fupeng Sun *IB*

### PEER REVIEW

Reviewer for academic journals: *Operations Research (OR)*, *Management Science (MS)*, *Manufacturing and Service Operations Management (M&SOM)*, *Mathematical Programming (MAPR)*, *Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR)*, *Mathematics of Operations Research (MOOR)*, *Foundations of Computational Mathematics (FOCM)*, *INFORMS Journal on Computing (IJC)*, *INFORMS Journal on Optimization (IJO)*, *SIAM Journal on Optimization (SIOPT)*, *Transportation Science (TS)*, *SIAM Journal on Matrix Analysis and Applications (SIMAX)*, *SIAM Journal on Mathematics of Data Science (SIMODS)*, *Operations Research Letters (ORL)*, *European Journal of Operational Research (EJOR)*.

- 2024 Meritorious Reviewer Award, INFORMS Journal on Computing.
- (Partial) evidence of reviewing activity at ORCID [link] and Web of Science [link]

Reviewer for extended abstracts/papers at conferences: EC 2026, ICML 2026, IPCO 2026, M&SOM 2025, IPCO 2024.

- 2026 gold reviewer (top 25%), ICML.